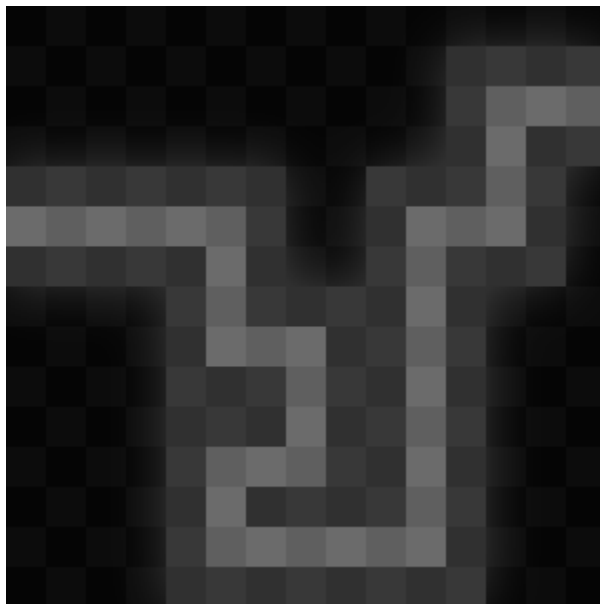
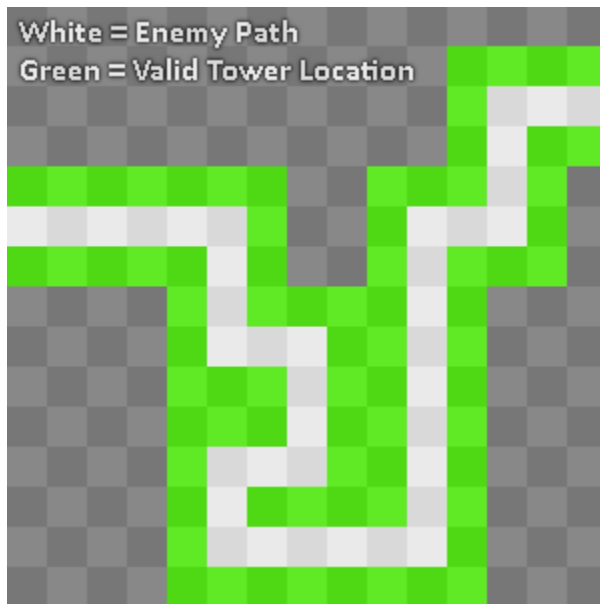


Map should be a 15x15 grid, and each tile of the path would validate the 8 surrounding tiles (excluding other path tiles) as valid tower placement locations. I thought going 2 out would be better, but after looking closer it ended up giving you too much track coverage.

Below it I have made a slightly more stylised version to make it more cavelike, with the lit up area being the valid placement location.



My ideas:

1. Change the game title from Pathfinder to Pathseeker, Pathfinder is already used by a popular RPG, and I think Pathseeker sounds cooler.
2. Mining/Underground aesthetic

3. Wave Mechanics

4. Once the game begins, there is no break between waves. Every 10th wave has an elite enemy / boss.

Enemy stats scale with the wave number.

The tunnel problem:



If someone were to make a path as long as possible for as much track coverage as possible, they should be 'punished' accordingly, and short paths should be rewarded somewhat.

After a certain amount of time has passed, enemies will stop rewarding money when defeated, but I also think that enemy movement speed should be scaled up on long maps and scaled down on shorter ones. Not too much, but I think it would help.

Waves should not be fully randomised, or fully preset.

5. Economy

The economy in this game should use Gold as the main currency if we follow the mining aesthetic, used for placing and upgrading towers.

To follow the roguelike mechanics, we should have random 'Relics' that are dropped by the boss enemies on the big waves.

As wave number increases, gold income should be reduced over time. Too many enemies would make the player too much money.

6. Towers

Generally: Towers should have an attack radius (float, not grid based), price, as well as damage and pierce (which gets passed to the projectile), and should own a vector of projectiles. Make it easy to add more towers.

If we can add tower upgrades in time, we could allow:

- 3 different upgrades, but you only get to choose 2 of them. (assuming this one)
- 2 upgrades (simple)
- 1 upgrade path, but you can upgrade multiple times.
- Option 1, but there's a second, expensive upgrade.

I'm thinking of a fantasy type for the towers.

Tower Ideas:

Torchman – a basic, cost-efficient unit that slings fire at enemies. Guy with a big torch.

Upgrades:

- 1: Faster Firing – attacks faster
- 2: Hotter Flames – Damage over time effect.
- 3: Longer Reach – more range

Demoman – an AoE specialist that throws dynamite at enemies.

Upgrades:

- 1: Bigger Blast – dynamite blast has more radius and pierce
- 2: Throwing Glove – more range and projectile speed
- 3: Violent Blast – more damage

Pickaxe Thrower – throws a pickaxe in an arc at enemies (imagine boomerang monkey)

Upgrades:

- 1: Sharper Pickaxe – damage and pierce
- 2: Spirit Slice – homing pickaxes
- 3: Gold Striker – occasionally throws gold pickaxes that give you more gold on kill (applies a debuff is what I'm thinking)

Spear Thrower – throws high pierce spears through enemies, excels when firing down straight lines.

Upgrades:

- 1: Faster Throwing – attacks faster
- 2: Better Technique – more projectile speed and pierce
- 3: Whetstone – more damage

Pulse Bot – releases short ranged electrical pulses, excels on track bends and corners.

Upgrades:

- 1: Bigger Pulses – much more radius
- 2: Harsher Pulse – more damage and pierce
- 3: Rapid Pulses – attack speed

Snowman – throws snowballs that slow down enemies

Upgrades:

- 1: Colder Temperature – slows down enemies more
- 2: Bigger Snowballs – more pierce
- 3: Iceballs – snowballs do damage

7. Enemies

I don't really have too much for generic enemy ideas. Generic stuff like goblins, skeletons, that kind of thing probably.

Every 10th wave the boss enemies should have some kind of gimmick, higher HP, and lower move speed.

I have a couple of ideas for these ones.

Evil Snowman – towers in a radius around it have reduced attack speed.

The Blob – regenerates HP over time, so you have to out-damage the healing.

8. Relics

I don't really have much for this either, but these have to be powerful and synergise with certain towers. If I got a relic that upgraded the Pulse Bot, I would want to place more Pulse Bots.

Sign Off:

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